Northwind Analytics: Remote Work and Equipment Policy

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This is a fictional company document created for a class exercise.

1. Purpose and scope

This policy describes how Northwind Analytics employees may work remotely, which equipment the company provides, and how expenses are reimbursed. It applies to all full-time and part-time employees, but not to contractors, who follow their own agreements.

2. Eligibility

Employees become eligible for remote work after completing a 90-day probation period. Employees on a performance improvement plan can be asked to work from an office for the duration of the plan. Remote work requests must be approved by the direct manager and recorded in the HR portal.

3. Core hours and availability

All remote employees must be reachable between 10:00 and 15:00 local time on working days. Outside those core hours, employees may set their own schedule, provided weekly contracted hours are met. Employees working across more than two time zones must get written approval from their manager.

4. Equipment

Northwind provides one laptop, one docking station and one monitor for each remote employee. Laptops are replaced every 36 months. Employees must report a lost or damaged device to IT within 24 hours. A lost device that is not reported in time is charged to the employee at 50 percent of its current book value.

5. Home office allowance

Each employee receives a one-time home office allowance of 25,000 Indian rupees for a desk, an ergonomic chair and lighting. Receipts must be submitted within 60 days of purchase. Unused allowance does not carry over to the next financial year.

6. Internet and phone

Northwind reimburses up to 1,200 rupees per month for home internet. Mobile phone costs are reimbursed up to 600 rupees per month when the employee uses a personal phone for work calls. Claims are submitted through the expense portal by the 5th of the following month.

7. Security requirements

Remote employees must connect through the company VPN when accessing internal systems. Screens must lock after 5 minutes of inactivity. Company data must not be stored on personal devices or in personal cloud accounts. Any suspected breach must be reported to the security team at security@northwind.example immediately.

8. Travel and co-working spaces

Employees may work from a co-working space once per week without prior approval. Working from a co-working space for more than one week in a row requires manager approval. Work must not be done in public places where confidential screens could be seen.

9. Review and changes

This policy is reviewed every year by the People Operations team. Changes are announced at least 30 days before they take effect. Questions about this policy should go to people-ops@northwind.example.